

Caregiver Getting Started Guide

Set up a dependable communication system, teach it without pressure, and keep it ready offline.

No account

No ads

No cloud profile

Works offline after loading

Give the communicator time, attention, and enough vocabulary to be heard, believed, and able to say something new.

1. Set up the device

- [] Open My Buddy while connected to the internet and wait for "Saved for offline use."
- [] Add the page to the Home Screen if the browser offers that option.
- [] Open it once more while online after an update, then test it in airplane mode.
- [] Keep another communication method available for emergencies and device failure.

2. Personalize safety information

Use Menu and enter only the information that is useful on this device. It stays in this browser on this device; it is not sent to a QNS account or server.

- [] Name
- [] Phone number
- [] Address, city, and state
- [] School
- [] Emergency information that should be spoken

3. Know the three main areas

- Sentence strip: selected words collect at the top. Delete removes one; Clear removes all; Speak reads the whole message.
- Core board: high-use words stay in fixed positions so the movement can become familiar.
- Right-side tools: Quick speaks saved urgent phrases; Find teaches a route; Menu contains setup and editing; History repeats recent words; Simple View makes targets larger.

How to support communication

Model, wait, and respond

- Model on the board while you speak. The communicator does not have to copy you.
- Use one more word than the person currently uses: model “want drink” after a one-word message.
- Pause long enough for the person to plan and move. Silence is processing time.
- Honor clear messages, especially no, stop, hurt, help, and bathroom-related messages.
- Treat unexpected combinations as possible communication before correcting grammar.

Avoid testing: “Show me ____” turns communication into a quiz. Instead, use the word naturally and let the person see where it is.

A 10-minute first session

Minute	What to do
0-2	Choose a motivating activity and keep the board within reach.
2-5	Model 3-5 useful words: want, more, help, stop, go.
5-8	Build one sentence without requiring imitation.
8-10	Let the communicator explore; respond to meaningful taps.

Editing and backups

- Use Edit board to add personally meaningful words inside the page where they belong.
- Use Back up words and settings after personalization and before changing devices.
- Photos, custom words, and personal information are stored locally and can disappear if browser data is erased.

Before relying on it away from Wi-Fi

- ☐ Airplane-mode test passed
- ☐ Speech volume is audible
- ☐ Charging plan is ready
- ☐ Backup file is stored safely
- ☐ A second way to communicate is available